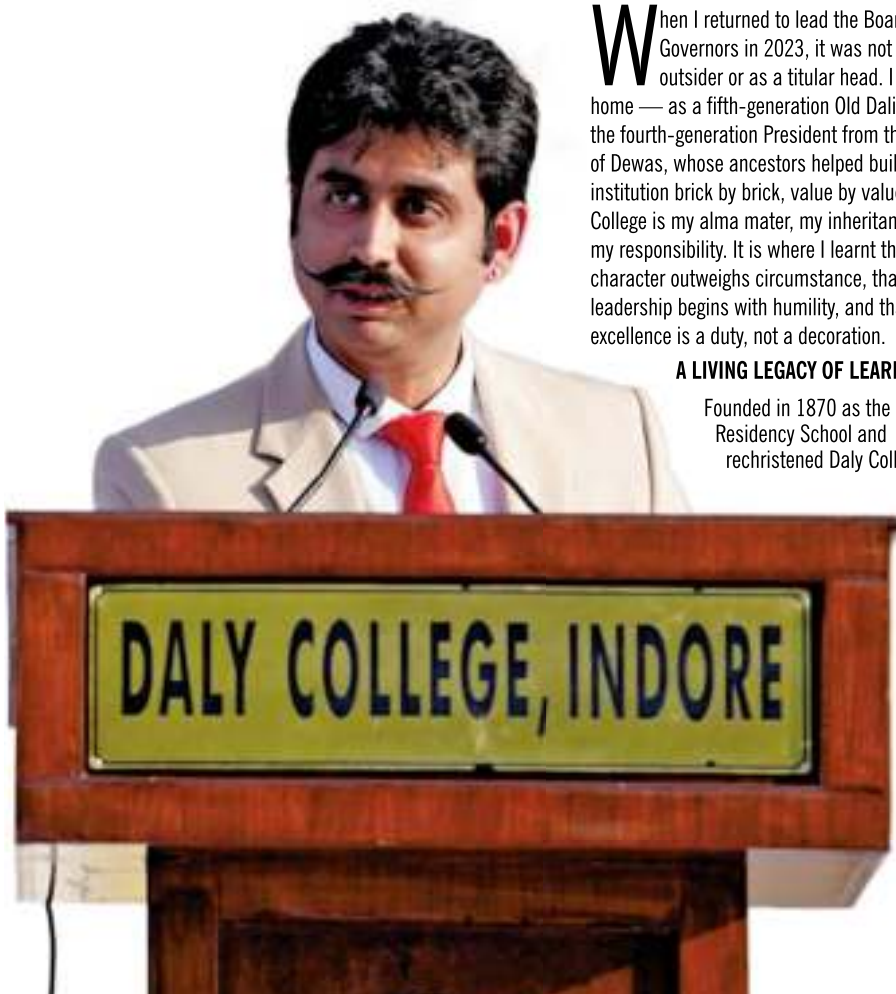
DALY COLLEGE, INDORE
WHERE LEGACY BREATHES, AND THE FUTURE LEARNS TO FLY

By HH Maharaja Vikram Sinh Puar of Dewas (Senior), President – Board of Governors, Daly College

There are places that teach, and then there are places that shape the idea of learning itself. For over a century and a half, Daly College – the "Jewel of Malwa" – has stood as one of India's most evocative educational landmarks. Its Indo-Saracenic arches, its avenues of ashoka and gulmohar, its echo of prayers and debates, all tell the story of a school that has never merely kept pace with time, but set its rhythm.



When I returned to lead the Board of Governors in 2023, it was not as an outsider or as a titular head. I came home — as a fifth-generation Old Dalian and the fourth-generation President from the House of Dewas, whose ancestors helped build this institution brick by brick, value by value. Daly College is my alma mater, my inheritance, and my responsibility. It is where I learnt that character outweighs circumstance, that leadership begins with humility, and that excellence is a duty, not a decoration.

A LIVING LEGACY OF LEARNING

Founded in 1870 as the Indore Residency School and rechristened Daly College in 1882 after General Sir Henry Daly, this was among the five original Raj Kumar Colleges — schools conceived to educate India's princely heirs in scholarship and service.

From those beginnings has evolved a day-cum-residential institution of global stature – now elevated to the Ivy League of Indian Schools by Education World 2025-26, a recognition reserved for the "best of the best" institutions that have consistently led across academics, sports, infrastructure, leadership, and inclusivity.

The essence of Daly's endurance lies in its ability to reinvent without losing its soul. Over the past three years, the college has undergone an academic renaissance — every classroom air-conditioned and digitised, every subject redesigned to match international benchmarks, every child encouraged to find a voice. The motto Gyanamev Shakti — Knowledge is Power — has moved from inscription to instinct.

TRADITION MEETING TOMORROW

Our approach is simple: preserve heritage, pursue innovation. Smart classrooms and AI-enabled pedagogy stand beside the century-old Scindia Pavilion. Robot teachers co-exist with house tutors who still write hand-inked notes of encouragement. The Computer Science Block hums with code; the library whispers history. At the same time, the restored Barwani and Ashok Houses and the rejuvenated Desai Lake remind every student that modernity draws its strength from memory.

A re-imagined sports complex — complete with an international-standard turf hockey

VIKRAM SINH PUAR
Chairman, Daly Board